

1 LAST CHECK LIST

Use this list to pressure-test the plan, surface the risks no one wants to say out loud, and make sure the idea survives contact with reality before you commit.

☐ **You're excited. Check your bias.**

Liking the idea isn't evidence. State why this move makes sense now without letting enthusiasm talk.

☐ **Compare at least one credible alternative.**

Document one viable alternative and why it lost. If you can't explain it, evaluation isn't done.

☐ **Authority $\neq$ correctness.**

A powerful sponsor doesn't validate the plan. Confirm the business case stands without their name on it.

☐ **Timelines must survive reality.**

Hours aren't weeks. Bake in delays, turnover, vendor lag, vacations, dependencies, and surprises.

☐ **Third-party work isn't under your control.**

Vendors have other priorities. Add margin for integration, missed handoffs, & shifting commitments.

☐ **Plan for technology aging.**

You're aiming for 3–5 years. Assume this isn't final; define an exit and successor path.

☐ **Internal impact outranks code.**

Who else is burdened? Confirm downstream teams are ready & value extends past the loud stakeholder.

☐ **Define success upfront.**

Write what "done" includes and excludes. If scope moves, you never finish.

☐ **Cost model includes transition.**

Account for people time, infra, parallel run, and licensing shifts. Overlap can kill ROI.

☐ **Alignment is risk management.**

Quiet dissent in engineering or ops slows delivery. Surface objections now and plan for them.

This checklist is the warm-up. 1LastCheck.com digs into your specifics before things get too hot.